

the French annexed the city and the archbishop elector's court was abolished. The small world in which Beethoven grew up had been erased while he flourished in Vienna.

The lessons with Haydn did not last long but, armed with introductions from Waldstein, Beethoven was patronized by some of the city's leading aristocratic music-lovers. Lodging at the palace of Prince Karl Lichnowsky, a patron of the arts in Vienna, the composer quickly won recognition as an outstanding piano virtuoso, giving performances in private salons and at public concerts of the Vienna Philharmonic Society. Listeners were astonished by his extraordinary skills,



STRING QUARTETS

The Takács Quartet performs the full cycle of Beethoven's 16 string quartets at Alice Tully Hall, New York, in 2005. Beethoven's quartets show his mastery of the Classical string quartet form.